

Background

Regular **communication** methods like video calls and text messages make it difficult to host joint activities that strengthen emotional bonds between **family** members that are physically separated.

Objective

Bun Appétit is a gamified family cookbook that transforms cooking experience into shareable memories for distant family members. We aim to leverage the hunger flow and **Nibbles**, the virtual bunny, as a kinkeeper to sustain continuous **interactions** and cooking experience sharing.

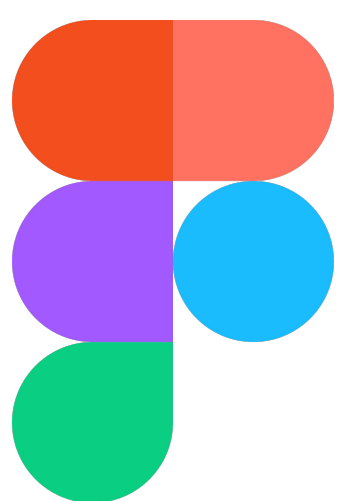
Problem Statement

We aim to answer the following **research questions** in this study:

- Can the gamification of joint activities facilitate emotional connection between distant family members?
- How do distant family members perceive the role of the gamified joint activity application in initiating and structuring their interactions?

Study Design

Analysis



2 week Diary study
Literature review
Big 3

Design

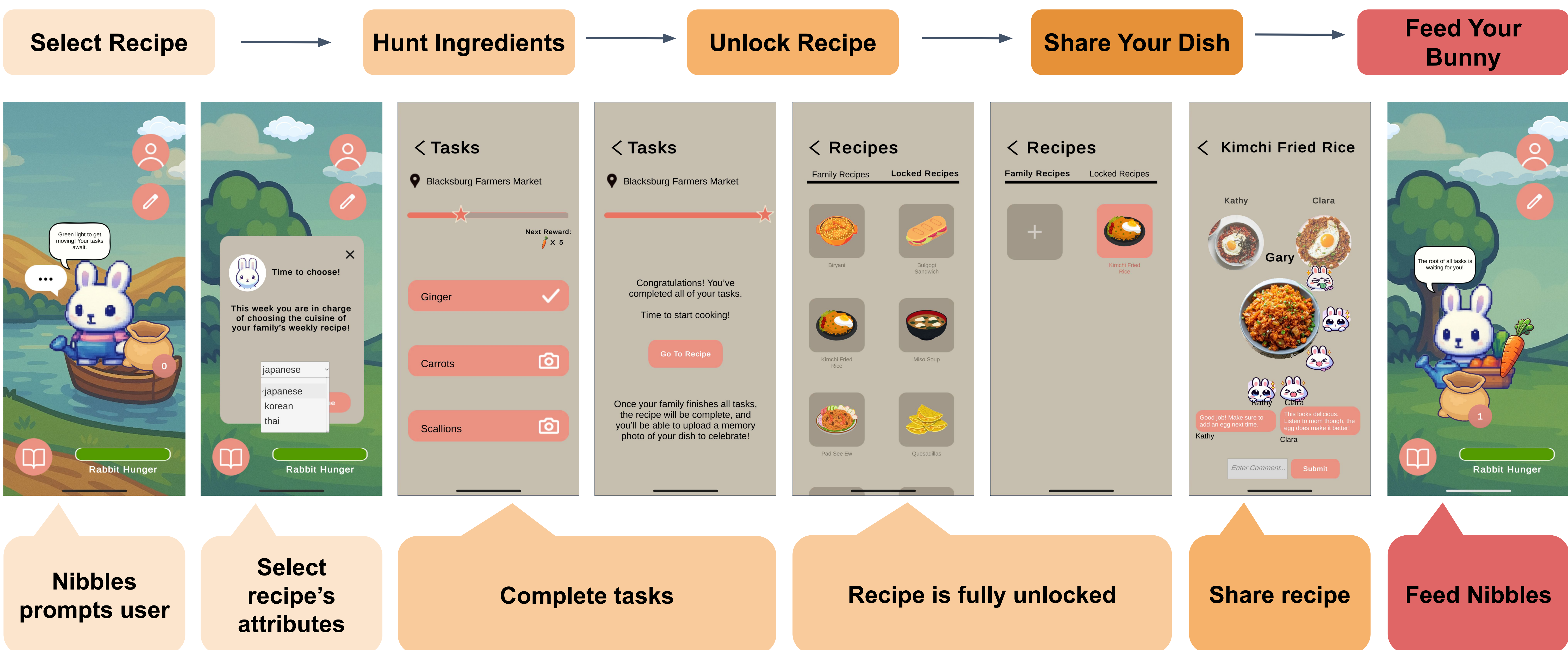
unity python
django OpenAI

Implement

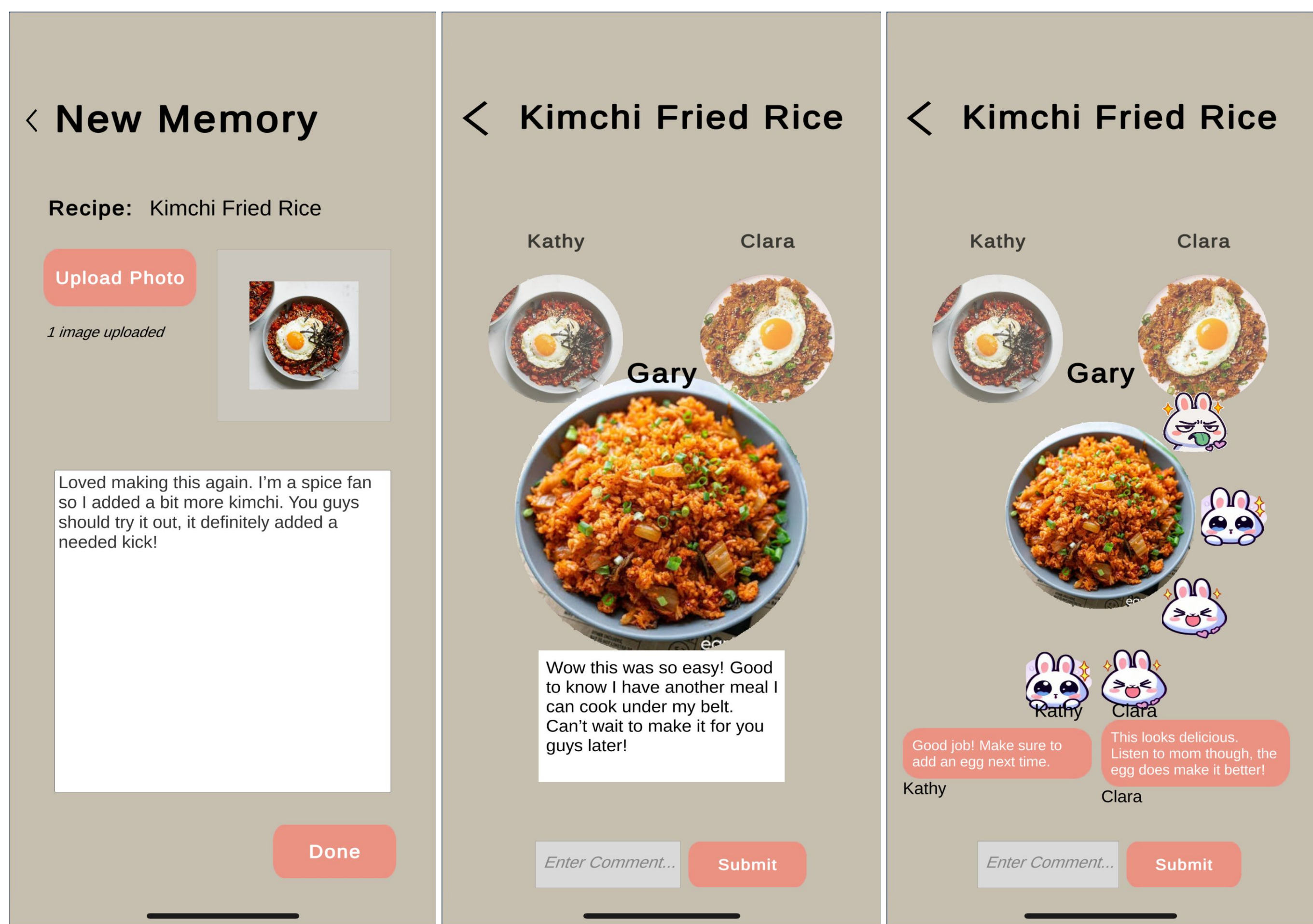
- 4 day user study with 6 families (n = 13)
- Completed 1 full cycle of the application
- Post-study questionnaire

Evaluation

Task Completion and Hunger Flow



Memory Creation and Reaction Flow



Record more experiences



Compare and comment on other dishes

Evaluation

Can the gamification of joint activities facilitate emotional connection between distant family members?

“Compared to previous experiences where conversations would often fizzle out or feel a bit forced... this design makes the joint activity feel more intentional and engaging.”

“Getting to see everybody's photos in one place and react/comment introduced a fun way to spark conversations.”

How do distant family members perceive the role of the gamified joint activity application in initiating and structuring their interactions?

“Users can make the same dishes and share with each other without having to communicate a lot about when they are cooking.”

“Feeding the bunny was a motivation to not let the tasks go undone for too long. It was satisfying to see the bunny hunger line all green.”